

just going to scare everyone away!” To be fair, they probably have a point. In fact, they *even* made me move a more reassuring paragraph about recursion from later in this foreword up to the second paragraph just so you wouldn’t first read about the stories of Ben and Chelsea and run away in a screaming horror to read a book about design patterns instead.

Clearly, writing the foreword to a book is serious business. So, regrettably, I’ll have to share the true stories of Ben and Chelsea with you another time. But, getting back to the book, it’s true that recursion is not a technique that gets applied to the vast majority of problems in day-to-day programming. As such, it often carries an aura of magic about it. This book hopes to dispel much of that. This is a good thing.

Finally, as you set off on your recursion journey, be prepared to have your brain bent in new directions. Not to worry—this is normal! However, it’s also important to stress that recursion is supposed to be a bit of fun. Well, at least a little bit. So, enjoy the ride!

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